

A YAHBIBLE STUDY

⌘ The Ten Commandments ⌚

Exodus 20

What each commandment means to keep and to violate — not only in deed, but in thought, desire, emotion, speech, and intent, and in the making of an idol even of the Son or of creation — with the scriptures for temptation and a prayer to guard the heart, soul, and mind.

“Think not that I am come to destroy the law, or the prophets: I am not come to destroy, but to fulfil.”

Matthew 5:17

COMMANDMENT 1 OF TEN

No other gods before YHWH

“Thou shalt have no other gods before me.”

EXODUS 20:3

ITS OPPOSITE

Idolatry — enthroning anything (self, wealth, power, a person, fear, even a good thing) in the place that belongs to YHWH alone.

TO KEEP IT INWARDLY

To love the LORD your God with all your heart, soul, and mind (Deuteronomy 6:5; Matthew 22:37) — He alone first in every affection, trust, and choice.

TO VIOLATE IT INWARDLY

Thought: Giving your inner allegiance or trust to another source of security or worth.

Desire: Wanting something — comfort, approval, gain — more than you want God Himself.

Emotion: Fearing man or loss more than you revere and love Him.

Speech: Pledging your devotion, by word or vow, to a lesser lord.

Intent: Ordering your life around anything but Him as your highest end.

Idol of the Son: Honouring the Son's created form yet forgetting the Father who sent Him: come to the Father THROUGH the Son (John 14:6), for 'my Father is greater than I' (John 14:28) — worship the Father in the Son, never the Son instead of the Father.

Mistaking creation for God: Worshipping the made thing — sun, self, nature — instead of the Maker (Romans 1:25).

WHEN YOU ARE TEMPTED

When another 'god' calls, name it and refuse it aloud as Yeshua did: 'Get thee behind me, Satan: for it is written, Thou shalt worship the Lord thy God, and him only shalt thou serve.'

Matthew 4:10 · Deuteronomy 6:5 · 1 Corinthians 10:13

A PRAYER TO GUARD HEART, SOUL & MIND

Father YHWH, be Thou alone the Lord of my heart, soul, and mind. Cast down every rival throne within me; let nothing be loved above Thee. Through Yeshua Thy Son I come to Thee, and Thee only will I serve. Amen.

COMMANDMENT 2 OF TEN

No idol or graven image

“Thou shalt not make unto thee any graven image... thou shalt not bow down thyself to them, nor serve them.”

EXODUS 20:4-5

ITS OPPOSITE

Reducing the invisible God to a thing you can see, hold, or control — and bowing to it.

TO KEEP IT INWARDLY

To worship God who is Spirit, in spirit and in truth (John 4:24); to let no image stand between your soul and the living God.

TO VIOLATE IT INWARDLY

Action: Making or serving an image or likeness as if it were divine.

Thought: Shrinking God to a manageable idea you can master, rather than the God who is.

Desire: Craving a visible, controllable god over the unseen and holy One.

Intent: Using a symbol, ritual, or religion to bend God to your will.

Idol of the Son: Making an idol even of the Son's image — venerating the form while missing the Father's heart it was given to reveal.

Creation-worship: Adoring the sun, the stars, the self, or nature as God (Romans 1:23-25).

WHEN YOU ARE TEMPTED

‘God is a Spirit: and they that worship him must worship him in spirit and in truth.’ Refuse every image that would replace Him, and keep yourself from idols.

John 4:24 · Romans 1:25 · 1 John 5:21

A PRAYER TO GUARD HEART, SOUL & MIND

Living God, Thou art Spirit; keep me from every idol of hand or mind. Let no image, symbol, or imagination stand where Thou alone belong. Reveal the Father to me through the Son, in spirit and in truth. Amen.

COMMANDMENT 3 OF TEN

Do not take His Name in vain

“Thou shalt not take the name of the LORD thy God in vain.”

EXODUS 20:7

ITS OPPOSITE

Using God’s Name emptily — as a curse, a careless oath, a cover for falsehood, or a badge with no life to match it.

TO KEEP IT INWARDLY

To hallow His Name (Matthew 6:9): let it be honoured in your speech and proven true by your life.

TO VIOLATE IT INWARDLY

Speech: Swearing by Him falsely, cursing, or invoking Him carelessly.

Intent: Using His Name to sanctify your own agenda or to cloak a deceit.

Heart: Bearing His Name as His child while living unlike Him, so the Name is blasphemed through you (Romans 2:24).

WHEN YOU ARE TEMPTED

Let your yes be yes and your no be no (Matthew 5:37). When tempted to profane the Name, bless it instead, and set a watch before your lips.

Matthew 6:9 · Matthew 5:37 · Psalms 19:14

A PRAYER TO GUARD HEART, SOUL & MIND

Father, hallowed be Thy Name in my mouth and in my life. Set a watch, O LORD, before my lips; let the words of my mouth honour Thee, and let my life never shame the Name I bear. Amen.

COMMANDMENT 4 OF TEN

Keep the Sabbath holy

“Remember the sabbath day, to keep it holy.”

EXODUS 20:8

ITS OPPOSITE

Restless, self-reliant striving that never ceases to trust and rest in God — or empty rule-keeping with no rest of heart.

TO KEEP IT INWARDLY

To cease from your own works and trust His; the sabbath was made for man (Mark 2:27); to enter His rest (Hebrews 4:9-10) in body and soul.

TO VIOLATE IT INWARDLY

Action: Driven, unceasing labour that denies you were made to rest in Him.

Thought: Believing everything depends on you, not on God's provision.

Emotion: Anxiety that cannot stop, be still, and trust.

Intent: Using even rest or religion to serve self, not to commune with God.

WHEN YOU ARE TEMPTED

‘Come unto me, all ye that labour and are heavy laden, and I will give you rest.’ Stop, trust, and worship; from His rest, love and labour rightly.

Matthew 11:28 · Mark 2:27 · Hebrews 4:10

A PRAYER TO GUARD HEART, SOUL & MIND

Lord of the Sabbath, teach me to cease and to trust. Quiet my striving; let my soul rest in Thee, that out of Thy rest I may love and work aright. Amen.

COMMANDMENT 5 OF TEN

Honour father and mother

“Honour thy father and thy mother.”

EXODUS 20:12

ITS OPPOSITE

Dishonour, contempt, neglect, or bitterness toward parents — and the rightful authority God set over your beginning.

TO KEEP IT INWARDLY

To honour, care for, and speak well of them; to receive with gratitude the life and lineage God gave you.

TO VIOLATE IT INWARDLY

Speech: Reviling, mocking, or cursing them (Matthew 15:4).

Emotion: Harboured contempt, resentment, or bitterness.

Thought: Despising them in your heart even while outwardly polite.

Action: Neglecting their need while claiming devotion to God (Mark 7:10-13, the ‘Corban’ evasion).

WHEN YOU ARE TEMPTED

Where honour is hard, ask God for grace to forgive and to bless; honour the office even amid the person's faults, that it may be well with you.

Ephesians 6:2 · Matthew 15:4 · Mark 7:11

A PRAYER TO GUARD HEART, SOUL & MIND

Father, teach me to honour those You set over my beginning. Heal every wound, root out all bitterness, and let me bless where I was tempted to curse; that it may be well with me in the land You give. Amen.

COMMANDMENT 6 OF TEN

Do not murder

“Thou shalt not kill.”

EXODUS 20:13

ITS OPPOSITE

The unjust taking of life — and its inward root, hatred.

TO KEEP IT INWARDLY

To cherish life as God’s gift, to be a peacemaker (Matthew 5:9), and to love even your enemy (Matthew 5:44).

TO VIOLATE IT INWARDLY

Emotion: Anger and hatred without cause: ‘whosoever is angry with his brother without a cause shall be in danger of the judgment’ (Matthew 5:22).

Speech: Contempt and cursing — ‘Raca’, ‘Thou fool’ (Matthew 5:22).

Thought: Wishing another dead or harmed: ‘whosoever hateth his brother is a murderer’ (1 John 3:15).

Action: Violence, or the destroying of another’s life, livelihood, or name.

WHEN YOU ARE TEMPTED

Be reconciled quickly (Matthew 5:23-24); let not the sun go down upon your wrath (Ephesians 4:26); be not overcome of evil, but overcome evil with good.

Matthew 5:22 · 1 John 3:15 · Romans 12:21

A PRAYER TO GUARD HEART, SOUL & MIND

Father, take from me all anger, hatred, and contempt; give me a peacemaker’s heart. Let me bless my enemy and guard the life and name of my brother. Create in me a clean heart, O God. Amen.

COMMANDMENT 7 OF TEN

Do not commit adultery

“Thou shalt not commit adultery.”

EXODUS 20:14

ITS OPPOSITE

Betrayal of the marriage covenant — and its inward root, lust.

TO KEEP IT INWARDLY

Faithfulness of body and heart; purity of eye and desire; the honouring of covenant.

TO VIOLATE IT INWARDLY

Desire: Lust: ‘whosoever looketh on a woman to lust after her hath committed adultery with her already in his heart’ (Matthew 5:28).

Thought: Entertaining and rehearsing longing for what is not yours.

Speech: Seductive, flattering, or unfaithful words.

Action: The deed itself; or breaking faith in any covenant of trust.

WHEN YOU ARE TEMPTED

Make a covenant with your eyes (Job 31:1); flee — do not linger — as Joseph fled (Genesis 39:12); cut off the occasion (Matthew 5:29-30). Your body is the temple of the Holy Spirit.

Matthew 5:28 · 1 Corinthians 6:18 · 2 Timothy 2:22

A PRAYER TO GUARD HEART, SOUL & MIND

Father, give me a pure heart and faithful eyes. Let me flee temptation as Joseph fled, and keep covenant in body, heart, and thought. My body is Thy temple; keep it holy. Amen.

COMMANDMENT 8 OF TEN

Do not steal

“Thou shalt not steal.”

EXODUS 20:15

ITS OPPOSITE

Taking what is not yours — and its root, greed and mistrust of God’s provision.

TO KEEP IT INWARDLY

To deal honestly, to give rather than take, to labour and to share (Ephesians 4:28).

TO VIOLATE IT INWARDLY

Action: Theft, fraud, cheating, or withholding what is owed (wages, debts, honour).

Desire: Coveting what belongs to another until you reach for it.

Intent: Planning to gain by another’s loss.

Thought: Believing you must seize because God will not provide.

WHEN YOU ARE TEMPTED

‘Let him that stole steal no more: but rather let him labour... that he may have to give to him that needeth.’

Trust God’s provision and be content.

Ephesians 4:28 · Hebrews 13:5 · Proverbs 30:8

A PRAYER TO GUARD HEART, SOUL & MIND

Father, You are my provider; deliver me from greed and from every dishonest gain. Make me a giver and not a taker; let my hands be clean and my heart content in Thee. Amen.

COMMANDMENT 9 OF TEN

Do not bear false witness

“Thou shalt not bear false witness against thy neighbour.”

EXODUS 20:16

ITS OPPOSITE

Lying, slander, and false accusation — and its root, the love of deceit.

TO KEEP IT INWARDLY

To speak the truth in love (Ephesians 4:15,25), to guard your neighbour's name, and to let your yes be yes.

TO VIOLATE IT INWARDLY

Speech: Lying, slander, gossip, or false accusation.

Thought: Believing and spreading a lie, or twisting the truth to your advantage.

Intent: Using words to harm, to gain unjustly, or to destroy a reputation.

Emotion: Secret pleasure in another's fall — the tongue set on fire (James 3:6).

WHEN YOU ARE TEMPTED

Speak truth, or be silent; refuse gossip. The devil is the father of lies (John 8:44) — walk in the light and let your words heal, never wound.

Ephesians 4:25 · James 3:6 · Proverbs 6:17

A PRAYER TO GUARD HEART, SOUL & MIND

Father of truth, let no lie live in my mouth or my heart. Set a guard over my tongue; let my words heal and never wound, and let me love the truth even when it costs me. Amen.

COMMANDMENT 10 OF TEN

Do not covet

“Thou shalt not covet... any thing that is thy neighbour’s.”

EXODUS 20:17

ITS OPPOSITE

Covetousness — the discontented craving for what is another’s; the hidden seedbed of all the rest.

TO KEEP IT INWARDLY

Contentment and gratitude; rejoicing in another’s good; desiring God above every gift.

TO VIOLATE IT INWARDLY

Desire: Craving your neighbour’s house, spouse, goods, status, or life.

Thought: Comparison, envy, and discontent with the portion God has given you.

Emotion: Resentment at another’s blessing — covetousness, which is idolatry (Colossians 3:5).

Intent: Scheming to obtain what is not yours — from this root grow theft, adultery, and murder.

WHEN YOU ARE TEMPTED

‘Take heed, and beware of covetousness: for a man’s life consisteth not in the abundance of the things which he possesseth.’ Be content, and set your desire on things above.

Luke 12:15 · Hebrews 13:5 · Philippians 4:11

A PRAYER TO GUARD HEART, SOUL & MIND

Father, root out every envious craving; teach me contentment and gratitude. Let me rejoice in my brother’s good and desire Thee above all Thou couldst give. The LORD is my portion. Amen.